Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report
Residential Care

Licensee: Homestead Youth & Family Services, Inc.
Executive Director: Elisa Doebler-Irvine
Board Chairperson: Joan Howard
Date of Unannounced: 6.29.2023
Licensing Coordinator: Jorge Pelinski
Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: Oregon Youth Authority (OYA)

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings Unannounced Site Visit 10/26/2023	Repeat Findings Further Action Needed	Comments
Physical Plant 413-215-0511(2)(a) &(c) Buildings are smoke free, clean and in good repair Sometime after the bathroom partition was repaired (see above), the material used to patch the partition was removed by youth in care. The program shall repair the hole in a way that is less susceptible to being re-damaged.	**Yes☐ No✓**	Agency used an epoxy finish, versus silicone caulking, for a more permanent fix.

New Findings from Site Visit	Comments
	No new findings and previous finding have been addressed.

Interview Summary
During the unannounced review I met with two youth and interviewed Executive Director, Elisa Doebler-Irvine. • Both youths interviewed stated things were going well at the program. • Both youths enjoy going on outings. Both youths enjoy playing sports and going on community outings. Both youths confirmed that they receive enough food to eat, and snacks are provided regularly. • Both youths make daily phone calls. • Both youths feel respected in the program. • Both youths feel safe in the program and feel comfortable talking with staff. Executive Director reported that several youths were acting overly aggressive while "horse playing". All youth received consequences for their actions. No injuries reported. Overall, the Executive Director shared that things are going well in the program. This writer followed up with Executive Director regarding some concerns youth raised during interviews which were: • Shower in B Hall – water pressure is low. I was informed from one of the Program Managers that the Plumber is coming next month to fix it. • One youth asked about wanting to go to church. Executive Director has been working on a plan, so youth can attend church regularly and is planning on talking with the team about virtual visit options. • Youth talked about wanting more snacks in between meals. I followed up with one of the program managers, and he stated that they get snacks at 8:30pm every night and during groups. It should be noted that youth get seconds on meals as well. I also spoke with the Executive Director regarding the feedback I got from the youth. • A youth shared that the food trap in the kitchen has not been cleaned for a while, which causes a foul odor when washing dishes. I followed up with the Executive Director and one of the Program Managers regarding this youth's feedback. The Program Manager stated that the food trap does get cleaned. The Executive Director is following up with team regarding feedback received by licensing coordinator from the youth interviewed.

Observations
Staff and youth were observed at the programs during the unannounced review. The youth that were at the programs, appeared to be at ease and comfortable in the environment. All areas of the program (inside and outside) where youth had access were observed to be well kept, clean and in good repair. Medication was observed to be in locked medication carts behind locked rooms which was inaccessible to the youth.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes:
Please submit the following to verify compliance.
Within 45 days of receipt of this report Homestead must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents can be emailed directly to Jorge Pelinski @ jorge.l.pelinski@odhsoha.oregon.gov **.**

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: _____ Date: _____

Manager Review: _____ Date: 7-17-2023